

Word family: **exchange / exchanges / exchanged / exchanging / exchangeable / exchange**

Base word: exchange

Past tense: exchanged

Past participle: exchanged

-ing form: exchanging

Related form: exchangeable

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “At first, it was nothing special because we only **exchanged greetings** in the lift from time to time.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **exchange** means that **two or more people give or communicate something to each other reciprocally**.

In **exchange greetings**, both people greet each other.

繁體中文： **雙方互相給予、表達或傳遞同類的說話、意見、眼神、信息等**

中文翻譯：

> “...we only **exchanged greetings** in the lift from time to time.”

「.....我們只是偶爾在電梯裡**互相打招呼**而已。」

Here:

exchange greetings = 雙方互相向對方打招呼

1. **exchange + words/greetings/ideas/information (說話 / 問候 / 想法 / 資料) — 互相交流 ; 交換**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: For two or more people to **give, communicate, or express something to one another**.

Practice 1 — Original

> “We only **exchanged greetings** in the lift from time to time.”

「我們只是偶爾在電梯裡**互相打招呼**。」

Practice 2

> “The two researchers **exchanged ideas** after the conference.”

「兩位研究人員在會議後**交流了想法**。」

Practice 3

> “They **exchanged a few words** before the meeting began.”

「會議開始前，他們**互相交談了幾句**。」

****exchange something = 雙方互相向對方傳遞或表達同類的說話、資訊、意見、感情或訊息****

Common examples:

- * exchange greetings
- * exchange ideas
- * exchange information
- * exchange opinions
- * exchange messages
- * exchange words
- * exchange glances

These do ****not**** need separate lexical meanings merely because the thing being exchanged changes. The Manual explicitly warns against splitting meanings based only on the following noun or context.

2. ****exchange + object for another object (物件) — 交換；以一物換另一物****

This is the basic physical transaction sense.

****Meaning:**** To give one thing and receive another thing in return.

Practice 4

> “The children ****exchanged gifts**** at the party.”

「孩子們在派對上****互相交換禮物****。」

Practice 5

> “I **exchanged** my old phone for a newer model.”

「我把舊手機**換**成了一部較新的型號。」

exchange one thing for another = 交出原本的物件，同時取得另一件物件作替代或回報

This differs slightly from reciprocal communication because here there is a clearer **one thing ↔ another thing** substitution.

3. **exchange a purchased item (已購買商品) — 換貨**

This is a very common retail meaning.

Meaning: To return something you bought and receive a different item instead, often because the size, colour, model, or condition is unsuitable.

Practice 6

> “Can I **exchange** this shirt for a larger size?”

「我可以把這件恤衫**換**成大一個尺碼嗎？」

Practice 7

> “The shop allows customers to **exchange** unwanted items within fourteen days.”

「這間商店容許顧客在十四天內**更換**不合適的商品。」

exchange a product = 把已購買的商品交回商店，換取另一件商品

I would keep this explicit because learners frequently encounter **refund vs exchange**, even though conceptually it develops from the broader “give one thing and receive another” meaning.

4. **exchange money/currency (貨幣) — 兌換貨幣**

Here, **exchange** means changing money from one currency into another.

Practice 8

> “I need to **exchange** some Hong Kong dollars for yen.”

「我需要把一些港幣**兌換成日圓**。」

Practice 9

> “You can **exchange currency** at the airport.”

「你可以在機場**兌換外幣**。」

exchange currency = 把一種貨幣按照匯率轉換成另一種貨幣

This is common enough to merit explicit treatment because the Chinese concept is specifically **兌換**, rather than ordinary 交換.

5. **exchange = give and receive something reciprocally (相互行為) — 互相給予 / 作出**

Some reciprocal actions are more abstract than merely exchanging information.

Common examples include:

- * exchange smiles
- * exchange glances
- * exchange blows
- * exchange insults
- * exchange kisses

Practice 10

> “They **exchanged smiles** across the room.”

「他們隔着房間**互相微笑示意**。」

Practice 11

> “The two players **exchanged angry words** after the match.”

「兩名球員賽後**互相說了幾句氣憤的話**。」

The broad concept remains:

each side does or gives something to the other

So I would **merge this with Meaning 1 for database counting**, rather than create separate senses for *smiles, glances, insults,* etc.

This follows the SOP's mandatory semantic-merging rule.

6. ****an exchange = reciprocal conversation/interaction (交談 / 互動) — 一番交流 ; 交談****

As a noun, ****exchange**** can refer to a short interaction in which people communicate with each other.

Practice 12

> "They had a brief ****exchange**** before the interview."

「訪問開始前，他們有過一番簡短的****交談 / 交流****。」

Practice 13

> "The discussion ended after a heated ****exchange****."

「那場討論在一番激烈的****言語交鋒****後結束。」

****an exchange = 雙方互相說話、回應或作出反應的一段互動****

Depending on context, it can be:

- * friendly exchange
- * brief exchange
- * heated exchange
- * angry exchange

The adjective changes the tone, but not necessarily the core lexical meaning.

7. ****exchange = system/place where goods, securities, etc. are traded (交易所 / 交易市場) — 交易所****

This is a distinct noun meaning.

****Meaning:**** An organized place or system where particular goods, financial assets, or contracts are bought and sold.

Practice 14

> "The company's shares are traded on the stock ****exchange****."

「這家公司的股份在股票**交易所**買賣。」

Practice 15

> “Trading on the **exchange** was unusually active that morning.”

「那天早上的**交易所交易**異常活躍。」

****exchange = 讓股票、商品、合約等按照一定規則進行買賣的正式市場或交易系統****

Common examples:

- * stock exchange
- * securities exchange
- * commodity exchange

This is genuinely different from two people exchanging objects or greetings.

8. ****exchange = organized programme where people temporarily swap places/countries (交流計劃) — 交流 ; 交換計劃****

This is especially common in education and international contexts.

Practice 16

> “She spent a semester in Canada on a student **exchange**.”

「她透過學生**交流計劃**到加拿大讀了一個學期。」

Practice 17

> “The schools have organized an **exchange programme** for their students.”

「兩間學校為學生安排了一項**交流計劃**。」

****exchange programme = 讓來自不同學校、地區或國家的人暫時到對方環境學習、工作或生活的安排****

This develops from the idea of reciprocal swapping, but it is lexicalized and useful enough to teach explicitly.

9. ****exchange rate (匯率) — 一種貨幣兌換另一種貨幣的比率****

This is an important compound.

Practice 18

> “The **exchange rate** has changed significantly this week.”

「本星期的**匯率**有明顯變化。」

Practice 19

> “Check the **exchange rate** before changing your money.”

「兌換貨幣之前先查看一下**匯率**。」

exchange rate = 一種貨幣可以兌換多少另一種貨幣的比率

This is best treated as a **family-extension compound**, not another independent meaning of bare **exchange**.

10. **in exchange for + something** — 作為交換；以.....換取.....

This is an important fixed expression.

Practice 20

> “He helped me with my project **in exchange for** dinner.”

「他幫我做專題，而我請他吃飯**作為交換**。」

Practice 21

> “The company offered free accommodation **in exchange for** volunteer work.”

「公司提供免費住宿，**以換取**義工服務。」

in exchange for something = 一方提供某物或作出某行動，以取得另一項回報

This does not require a wholly new lexical meaning; it is a highly useful fixed construction built from the core exchange concept.

Important distinction: **exchange** vs **change**

This is a major learner issue.

exchange

usually involves:

> one thing being given and another received in return

> “I **exchanged** the shirt for a larger one.”

「我把恤衫**換成**大一個尺碼。」

change

is much broader:

> make something different

> “I **changed** my shirt.”

「我**換了衣服 / 換了恤衫**。」

That does not imply returning one shirt and receiving another from a shop.

For currency:

> **exchange money**

= 把一種貨幣兌換成另一種

> **change money**

can also be used in some contexts, but **exchange currency** is especially clear for foreign-currency conversion.

Important distinction: **exchange vs swap**

These often overlap.

exchange

Neutral and suitable in both formal and informal contexts.

- > exchange information
- > exchange currency
- > exchange gifts

swap

Usually more informal and often emphasizes directly trading one thing for another.

- > “We **swapped seats**.”

「我們交換了座位。」

- > “Can we **swap phones** for a minute?”

「我們可以暫時交換手機嗎？」

Exchange has a much wider formal range, including:

- * exchange rates
- * stock exchange
- * exchange programmes
- * exchange information

where **swap** would often be inappropriate.

Important distinction: **exchange** vs **return**

Especially important in shops.

return an item

= give the item back to the seller

You may receive a refund.

exchange an item

= give the item back and receive another item instead

So:

> **return** = 退貨

> **exchange** = 換貨

A customer can return something **without exchanging it**.

Important distinction: **exchange vs refund**

exchange

You receive another item.

refund

You receive your money back.

> “Would you like an **exchange** or a **refund**?”

「你想**換貨**還是**退款**？」

This is a very useful practical distinction for learners.

Countability note

Exchange can be countable or used in compounds depending on meaning.

Countable interaction

> “They had an interesting **exchange**.”

= 一番交流

Countable trading institution

> “Several major **exchanges** operate internationally.”

= 幾個主要交易所

Common compound

> “**exchange rate**”

= 匯率

The intended meaning must come from context.

Family-extension note

Useful modern family members and expressions include:

* **exchange**
* **exchanged**
* **exchanging**
* **exchangeable**
* **exchange rate**
* **stock exchange**
* **exchange programme**
* **student exchange**
* **foreign exchange**
* **in exchange for**

exchangeable

= capable of being exchanged or replaced by another

> “The tickets are not **exchangeable**.”

「這些門票**不能更換 / 不能換成其他場次或票種**。」

foreign exchange

= the system/business of exchanging different national currencies

> “She works in **foreign exchange**.”

「她從事**外匯業務**。」

These are useful extensions, but the Manual says compounds and related forms should be labelled accurately rather than falsely presented as additional meanings of the base word.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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exchange greetings/ideas/information	雙方互相向對方表達、傳遞或給予同類的說話、想法、資訊或反應
exchange one thing for another	交出一件物品或事物，同時取得另一件作替代或回報

	exchange a purchased item	把已購買的商品交回商店，再換取另一件商品
	exchange currency	按照匯率把一種貨幣轉換成另一種貨幣
	an exchange — interaction	雙方互相說話、回應或作出反應的一段交流或交談
	exchange — trading institution	讓股票、商品、證券等按照規則進行買賣的正式交易市場或系統
	exchange programme	讓不同學校、地區或國家的人暫時到對方環境學習、工作或生活的交流安排
	in exchange for	提供某物或作出某行動，以取得另一項回報；作為交換
	exchange rate	一種貨幣可以兌換多少另一種貨幣的比率
	exchangeable	可以被交換、更換或以另一項事物替代的

For your original sentence

> “We only ****exchanged greetings**** in the lift from time to time.”

The exact meaning is:

****exchange = 雙方互相向對方給予、表達或傳遞某些東西****

More specifically:

****exchange greetings = 雙方互相向對方打招呼****

So the natural translation is:

> ****we exchanged greetings = 我們互相打招呼****

For your database, I would count ****7 useful core polysemy/polyfunctionality meanings**** for ****exchange****:

1. ****reciprocally communicate/give something — exchange greetings, ideas, information****
2. ****give one thing and receive another****
3. ****retail — replace a purchased item with another****
4. ****currency — convert one currency into another****
5. ****noun — an interaction/conversation****
6. ****noun — organized trading market/exchange****
7. ****organized exchange programme****

I would treat ****exchange rate****, ****foreign exchange****, and ****in exchange for**** as important compounds/fixed expressions rather than inflate the core polysemy count.